strategic policy making."[7] On Pakistan's side, Musharraf's reckless launching of the Kargil war a few years after Brasstacks might have led to nuclear war had Prime Minister Sharif been as reckless as his COAS.

Soon after the dawn of the new millennium, on 11 September 2001, New York City suffered diabolically unparalleled terrorist attacks. The minds that conceived of and coordinated those assaults on the symbols of world trade and cooperation were Al- Qaeda Saudi Muslims living in Afghanistan as the guests of Mullah Omar. The devastating damage and terror ignited on that day of darkness could have been magnified thousands of times had nuclear bombs been added to those hijacked planes.

Just as the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan little more than a decade earlier had, with massive infusions of U.S. aid, saved Zia's regime from collapsing of its own ineptitude, Pervez Musharraf's decision to join the U.S. "war" against terror, in response to Secretary of State Colin Powell's warning not to hesitate, saved his regime from bankruptcy, bringing a fresh influx of $10 billion in new weapons to America's revived front-line ally. The tragedy, however, was that the new regime in Washington, led by George W. Bush and Dick Cheney, abandoned the fight against Al-Qaeda before its leaders could be caught or killed in their Pakistani caves under the North-West Frontier, instead sending U.S. troops to fight and die in their ill-fated wasteful war in Iraq. Just when the entire world most strongly sympathized with the United States and stood ready to do everything possible to crush the threat to world peace posed by Al-Qaeda, Bush withdrew from the Afghan-Pakistani Waziristan border special U.S. forces closing in on Osama bin Laden and his followers, ordering them instead into the quagmire of Iraq. A misguided cabal of White House and Pentagon-led neoconservatives, intoxicated with oil, in this way caused much tragic damage to the world and countless deaths.

Prime Minister Vajpayee immediately offered India's support to Washington's new global struggle against terror, but since Pakistan was much closer to Afghanistan, the major support base of Osama bin Laden's followers, bolstered by Mullah Omar's Taliban, New Delhi's offer was turned down in favor of General Musharraf's. India was, therefore, obliged to watch with reawakened and growing anxiety as fresh American arms poured into the port of Karachi and were flown to every major airfield in Pakistan, reviving dreadful memories of what had happened to similar missiles and bombs left in the hands of terrorists